

Installation & Setup Guide

Project: LearnLens AI

1. Prerequisites

Before running LearnLens AI, verify your workstation meets the following minimum prerequisites:

1. Python 3.10 or higher:

Check with `python --version`

2. Node.js v18.0 or higher & npm:

Check with `node --version` and `npm --version`

3. Google Chrome / Chromium:

Required for browser tab capture and extension support.

2. One-Command Master Startup

The easiest way to start LearnLens AI:

```
python run.py
```

Or double-click `start_learnlens.bat` on Windows!

This master launcher automatically:

1. Verifies local packages.
 2. Initializes the SQLite database schema (`data/learnlens.db`).
 3. Seeds the high-yield educational demo session for instant testing.
 4. Starts the local FastAPI backend on `http://127.0.0.1:8000`.
 5. Starts the Vite frontend on `http://localhost:5173`.
 6. Automatically opens your default web browser to the application studio!
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3. Optional Local Ollama Setup (For Advanced Local Models)

LearnLens AI works completely out-of-the-box using its built-in educational heuristic reasoning engine. If you want to use local open-weight language models via Ollama:

1. Download Ollama from ollama.com.

2. Start Ollama:

```
ollama serve
```

3. Pull recommended educational models:

```
ollama pull qwen2.5:latest
ollama pull qwen2.5-vl:latest
```

4. LearnLens AI will automatically detect Ollama at `http://localhost:11434` and switch the green indicator to "Connected"!

4. Loading the Chrome Extension (Optional Companion)

1. Open Google Chrome and navigate to `chrome://extensions/``.
2. Enable "**Developer mode**" via the toggle in the top-right corner.
3. Click "**Load unpacked**".
4. Select the `extension/`` directory inside this repository.
5. Click the puzzle icon in Chrome to pin **LearnLens AI Companion**.
6. You can now use the Chrome Side Panel directly while browsing educational courses!